

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

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DJIA 49490.03 ▲ 340.65 0.69% NASDAQ 24657.57 ▲ 1.6% STOXX 600 613.88 ▼ 0.3% 10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 1/32, yield 4.293% OIL \$92.96 ▲ \$3.29 GOLD \$4,732.50 ▲ \$34.10 EURO \$1.1705 YEN 159.49

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **The Trump administration** is nearing a loan-for-warrants agreement to rescue Spirit Airlines in what would be a rare intervention to prop up a single carrier. **A1**
- ◆ **Tesla reported** better revenue and earnings for the first quarter when compared with last year's period and surprised Wall Street with positive free cash. **B1**
- ◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** rose, with the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow industrials advancing 1%, 1.6% and 0.7% respectively. **B1**
- ◆ **Wall Street's watchdogs** are intensifying their inquiries into how much risk has built up in the \$3 trillion private-credit industry just as some backers head for the exits. **A1**
- ◆ **Boeing's first-quarter** sales rose 14% from a year earlier to \$22.2 billion, helped by its recovering passenger jet business and growth in its defense and space segment. **B1**
- ◆ **Anthropic is investigating** potential unauthorized access to its new Mythos artificial-intelligence model, complicating efforts to keep a tight lid on the tool. **B1**
- ◆ **The NFL met with** senior FCC officials to justify the league's media-rights strategy as regulators scrutinize the migration of sports to streaming platforms. **B3**
- ◆ **Alphabet's Google** has developed a new processor customized for the type of computing operations involved in querying, rather than training, AI models. **B4**
- ◆ **Lululemon chose** as its next CEO former Nike executive Heidi O'Neill, who is expected to start in September. **B2**

Worldwide

- ◆ **The conflict with Iran** entered a damaging new phase between war and peace that leaves the Strait of Hormuz closed and the prospect of escalation looming. **A1, A7-9**
- ◆ **The U.S. is exploring** ways to reset ties with Eritrea, whose long Red Sea coastline makes it a strategic asset in the maneuvering to assert maritime-traffic rights. **A7**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** suspended U.S. dollar shipments to Iraq and froze security cooperation programs with its military, adding to pressure on Baghdad to dismantle Iran-backed militias. **A8**
- ◆ **John Phelan was fired** as Navy secretary after months of simmering tension with Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth and deputy defense chief Steve Feinberg. **A3**
- ◆ **Ukraine is poised** to receive an EU lifeline of more than \$100 billion after Hungary dropped its veto on financing vital for Kyiv's defense. **A7**
- ◆ **Kalshi said it fined** and suspended three congressional candidates for betting on their own races in what the predictions marketplace called political insider trading. **A4**
- ◆ **The IRS won another** battle in its fight against tax-motivated business transactions as an appeals court backed the government over telecom company Liberty Global. **A6**
- ◆ **A Colorado prosecutor** said an immigration officer was charged with third-degree assault and criminal mischief after an investigation into the treatment of a protester. **A4**
- ◆ **Died: David Scott**, 80, Georgia congressman. **A4**

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Wildfires Explode Along Georgia-Florida Border



GEORGIA FOREST COMMISSION

IN FLAMES: The Pineland Road Fire, one of multiple blazes, rages Wednesday in southeast Georgia. Dozens of homes have been destroyed and several pets killed. Drought, low humidity and changeable winds created ideal conditions for the outbreaks. **A3**

U.S. Nears Loan Deal to Rescue Spirit Airlines From Fiscal Hole

Trump and his aides look at potential \$500 million lifeline for stake in carrier

The Trump administration is nearing a rescue deal for Spirit Airlines, which is struggling to survive as jet fuel prices continue to rise. Under the agreement being discussed, the U.S. government would loan the discount carrier as much as \$500 million, receiving in return war-

rants to take a potential significant stake in Spirit, people familiar with the matter said. The investment could help keep Spirit afloat as it seeks to emerge from its second recent bankruptcy filing. The Transportation Department and Commerce Department are involved in the discussions, which aren't final, and the terms of any agreement could still change. President Trump met Tuesday night with Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick and Transportation Secretary Sean

By Alison Sider, Brian Schwartz and Andrew Scurria

Duffy to hash out a deal to keep Spirit Airlines alive, people with knowledge of the talks said. "This is something the Commerce Department and the president are tracking," White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt said Wednesday. "The aviation industry is very important to this president and this White House. Millions of Americans depend on it."

A rescue deal for Spirit, known for its bright yellow planes and cut-rate fares, would expand a series of private-sector investments that Trump has overseen in his second term. Those have included government-owned stakes in companies his administration considers strategically important. Last year the federal government became Intel's largest shareholder, acquiring nearly 10% of the semiconductor manufacturer's shares by

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GOP Fears Campaign To Redraw Districts Is Backfiring

Republicans are increasingly worried that a battle President Trump started last summer to redraw congressional district lines has backfired and might hand more seats to Democrats.

By Aaron Zitner, Alex Leary and Terrell Wright

At best, some Republicans say, the effort will produce only a small gain in the number of GOP House seats instead of the firewall the party was hoping to build to stave off the loss of its House majority in the midterm elections. Some in the party said on Wednesday that Trump, a Republican, and his aides had miscalculated by pressing Texas last year to undertake an unusual, mid-decade effort to draw new House district lines to the GOP's advantage. That redistricting prompted several Democratic-leaning states to redraw their own maps in response. And some questioned why Trump's political machine didn't spend more resources on Tuesday's election in Virginia, given the narrow outcome. Voters in Virginia on Tuesday passed one of the nation's most aggressive gerrymanders that, should it survive court challenges, would put Democrats in position to win 10 of the state's 11 House seats and leave the party with a slight overall advantage in the na-

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INSIDE



SPORTS

The Jets and Giants have never been worse—this NFL draft could save them. **A16**



GLEN WILSON/LONGGATE/AP

BUSINESS & FINANCE

The Michael Jackson biopic that nearly blew up is now poised to be a hit. **B1**

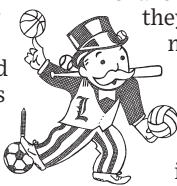
Massachusetts Teens Have Had It With Their Millionaire Mascot

* * *

Lenox students want the mockery to end, but the Monopoly Man won't go quietly

By OWEN TUCKER-SMITH

Lauren Bridges is sick of being a millionaire. Too bad she lives in Lenox. The high school in this well-off nook of the Berkshires has for a century shunned the Wildcats, Falcons, Bulldogs and other popular mascots in favor of the flashier "Lenox Millionaires." Think the Monopoly Man—top hat, tuxedo, dollar sign and all. He's not for everyone. Local athletes, tired of snarky comments from competitors, have bemoaned the name for years. Their parents have routinely complained to the superintendent, who re-



Go directly to jail

cently conducted a public-opinion poll to gauge interest in a switch. The mere suggestion has split the town, pitting younger detractors against older Lenox Millionaires, who shake their heads at what they see as the community's ignorance of its history and tradition. The vote is dragging this town into a debate over whether it's OK to tie a region's identity to its historical affluence. During the Gilded Age, many of the Eastern Seaboard's socialites and financiers—including families linked to J.P. Morgan and Edith Wharton—built sprawling estates to serve as sum-

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Private-Credit Risks Draw More Inquiries

Wall Street's watchdogs are ramping up their inquiries into how much risk has built up in the \$3 trillion private-credit industry, just as investor angst has sparked some backers to head to the exits.

By Dave Michaels, Dylan Tokar and Gina Heeb

The Securities and Exchange Commission in recent months has opened several enforcement investigations of large private-credit managers, according to people familiar with the matter. The Treasury

Department has requested information from private fund managers and insurance firms about their business models. Bank regulators, too, have stepped up their focus on the risks posed by the industry, with the Federal Reserve querying banks about their lending and exposure to private credit.

Regulators have been watching for risks stemming from the growing private-credit market for years, but

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◆ **Heard on the Street: Funds face balance-sheet test.... B12**

From Prison Gang To Cocaine Power

Brazil's PCC targets U.S. and European markets; pirate attacks in the Amazon

By SAMANTHA PEARSON

SÃO PAULO—A Brazilian gang founded in the country's violent prisons is fast becoming one of the world's biggest criminal organizations, reshaping cocaine flows from South America to Europe's busiest ports and edging into the U.S. Long under Washington's radar, the First Capital Command, known by its Portuguese initials PCC, started out as a disgruntled band of inmates fighting for soap and toilet paper in the 1990s. It now has some 40,000 members behind bars and on the streets with a vast net-

work of affiliates—making it the largest criminal group in the Americas by some estimates, operating in nearly 30 countries on every continent except Antarctica. "The PCC has become a truly transnational group," said Lincoln Gakiya, Brazil's top PCC prosecutor, who has tracked its rise for two decades. "I believe it is now the fastest-growing criminal organization in the world." With the scale of Italian organized criminal groups and the efficiency of a multinational corporation, the PCC has helped drive record cocaine seizures in Europe

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